

Top 20 Overseas Indians



An army of ambassadors for Brand India, billionaire businessmen, writers and professionals, these men and women are global citizens.

For the first time we have included Non-Resident Indians (NRIs) in our High and Mighty list, and it is a legitimate addition. Every time the prime minister travels abroad on an official visit, the itinerary always includes a reception for the local NRIs. It's not knee-jerk tokenism. NRIs or Persons of Indian Origin have become an increasingly influential force in key world capitals, most notably London and New York. An American of Indian origin is being projected as the presidential candidate for the Republican Party in the next US election. Another has served as the premier of Mauritius while President Barack Obama has named a person of Indian origin for an important cabinet position. Official positions are one side of the NRI story. More important is the lobbying they can do to influence decisions that affect India, most notably the role they played in pushing the Indo-US nuclear deal. They also form a significant slice of the global business community. Indian business tycoons regularly feature on the *Forbes*' list of the world's richest. They also dominate the IT industry worldwide, as entrepreneurs and software professionals and have a prominent representation in the world's best universities and research institutions. With an estimated over 25 million NRIs across the world, they symbolise a formidable army of ambassadors for Brand India, a role they continue to raise to a new level. That transition has been helped as they represent the most affluent immigrants in almost every country, giving them a powerful voice. Added to that is the huge global impact of India's soft power, its culture, its music, its movies, and its literary voice. Indian authors are increasingly taking top honours at literary awards and churning out critically acclaimed books at an unprecedented rate. For this reason, the NRI ranking will be an annual feature in our High and Mighty listing.

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